Proposal of AISA

1. What is AISA?

AISA (Artificial Intelligence Scholars' Association) has been established as an independent student association, designed to consolidate networking among BAI students and achieve extracurricular educational goals. Our primary mission is to create a practical and lasting collaborative network, enriching both the university experience and future professional endeavors. AISA will adopt English as its official language. Initially, the association will welcome a maximum of 20 members; this restriction is a deliberate organizational choice. This ensures that every member can provide a fair and relevant contribution while making projects manageable and productive. Participation is aimed at motivated students who are willing to contribute actively to the association's initiatives. Furthermore, it is ideal for members to possess a sufficient level of programming and machine learning.

2. Goals of the association

AISA proposes the following goals as its core mission:

2.1 Technical depth beyond the curricular program

The association intends to offer BAI students the opportunity to explore projects and techniques/software not yet covered, not put into practice, or only introduced in official courses. The goal is not to replace course teachings, but rather to integrate them with practical and experimental activities.

2.2 Projects

Primarily, AISA will focus on the development of practical projects (similar to exams such as Machine Learning or Artificial Neural Networks and Deep Learning), organized in small groups (3–4 students), featuring:

- A clear definition of objectives (including a "model" of the final project).
- A breakdown of responsibilities.
- Documentation of the work performed.
- Publication of code on the association's GitHub repository (or website).
- A brief technical explanation written by the project creators (for both public outreach and internal knowledge sharing).

This method will allow AISA members to:

- Gain additional experience on projects geared toward jobs or internships.
- Promote a peer-to-peer learning model, where members train each other by sharing skills (conducting research, finding similar projects, reading textbooks, experimenting with software, etc.).
- Build a project portfolio prior to the completion of the degree.

At the end of the activities, AISA will compile a detailed public portfolio on GitHub, documenting the individual contributions of each member. Each project would have a duration of approximately one month, allowing for a variety of skills to be practiced and groups to be rotated.

2.3 Introduction to research (interpretation and reproduction)

AISA plans to organize:

- A monthly or bimonthly selection of a scientific paper for in-depth study and discussion (ideally relevant to ongoing projects).
- The publication of a simplified explanation and interpretation on the association's page, co-authored by multiple members.
- A simplified reproduction of experimental results.

2.4 Fostering relationships among BAI students

AISA intends to create opportunities for:

- Equitable collaboration between students with different skills, interests, and experiences.
- Dialogue between students from different years of the course.
- Positive representation of the degree program by organizing activities open to external participants.

2.5 Engagement with external entities

Once technical skills among members have been consolidated and aligned, AISA aims to analyze real-world case studies or datasets provided by external entities (specifically humanitarian or non-profit organizations). The goal is not to provide consulting or software development, but to use these concrete scenarios as a basis for applied research and experimentation. All code, models, and proof-of-concepts developed will be published exclusively on the association's GitHub repository under an Open Source license.

2.6 Hackathons and competitions

As an association, AISA will participate in existing Hackathons (likely divided into subgroups). Furthermore, subject to approval and space availability, we propose to organize a small, self-funded internal hackathon at the university, tentatively scheduled for the end of the semester's lectures.

3. Organizational structure

The association features a structure where every member has a defined role. Every member has equal opportunities to contribute to and/or propose and manage various initiatives. The undersigned will maintain the roles of Co-founders for matters regarding:

- Communication with you and, potentially, other Professors.
- Verification of attendance documentation and project collaboration.
- Member selection.

Other assigned roles will include:

- Organizational Representative: To facilitate communication, group management, and address logistical issues.
- Technical Lead (one or two): Manages the GitHub repository, performs code reviews before publication, guides software selection, and supervises the choice of the reference model.
- Research Lead: Selects the scientific paper for in-depth study and oversees the final check before publication.
- Communications Lead: Monitors opportunities for Hackathons and manages the first point of contact with external entities or companies.

4. **Desired support**

AISA will operate as an independent and self-funded group. However, to ensure our activities align with the quality of the BAI program and represent real value for its members, we kindly request:

- The occasional and non-binding availability of the Coordinator or faculty members suggested by you to discuss chosen project themes, provide feedback, or point out datasets of particular academic interest.
- Consistent with the regulations of the three universities regarding informal groups, the occasional use of vacant classrooms for our meetings and the end-of-semester hackathon.
- Permission to briefly present our initiative (via an announcement in class or on the notice board) to BAI students to reach potential interested members.

We remain fully available to adapt to the procedures you deem most appropriate.

Co-founders:

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